

Robin Rowland

Wildlife ecologist with demonstrated experience in data management, technical analysis and reporting, and stakeholder engagement across academic, government, and community partners. Skilled in maintaining large ecological datasets and communicating complex scientific information to diverse audiences. Proven project coordination and committee experience, with strong statistical analysis skills in R.

1 Education

2023–Present — Doctor of Philosophy

University of the Sunshine Coast

Thesis: Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats

Anticipated completion: December 2026

2012–2016 — Bachelor of Arts (Honours Program),

Animal Behaviour

Eckerd College, USA

2 Relevant Experience

2.0.1 PhD Researcher — University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD

Feb 2023–Present

- Lead a research project examining the effects of urbanisation and roost environments on insectivorous bat health and physiology.
- Developed an open-access continental-scale database of Australian bat roost associations and a complementary functional-trait database.
- Work with private landholders, non-profit organisations, state and local government, and communicate findings to stakeholders.
- Mentor and assist with supervision and experimental design of six student research projects, including three undergraduate and three honours projects.

2.0.2 Bat Walk Workshop Leader — Moreton Bay Council, QLD

Oct 2024–Present

- Organise and lead annual citizen-science bat walks and public workshops.

2.0.3 Student Scholar — GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks

Mar 2024–Present

- Participate in international working groups and meetings involving bat researchers, conservation practitioners and other specialists.
- Collaborate on a global review of Data Deficient bat species, including creation, cleaning and management of a large citation database.
- Contribute to development of globally relevant scientific communication guidelines through the Global Bat Communication Guidelines Working Group.

2.0.4 Tutor — University of the Sunshine Coast, QLD

Mar 2023–Present

ANM100 — Animal Ecology Field Course

- Deliver course content on bat acoustics and provide support and instruction for first-year university students during field courses to North Stradbroke Island (Minjerribah).
- Demonstrate ecological field techniques including transects, acoustic monitoring and animal identification across diverse terrains.

ANM103 — Animal Form and Function

ENS222 — Terrestrial Vertebrate Diversity & Ecology

- Instruct university students in laboratory techniques and scientific writing.
- Moderate student discussions and mark assessments.
- Lead student groups on vertebrate identification field trips.

2.0.5 Outreach Coordinator — Tamborine Mountain Glow Worm Caves, QLD

Aug 2017–Feb 2023

- Liaised with tour and school groups, production companies and news agencies to deliver tailored wildlife conservation information.
- Represented the organisation at academic conferences and in communication with the public and scientific community.

2.0.6 Volunteer — Southern Cross University Glider Program, Brisbane, QLD

Aug 2019–Nov 2019

- Captured, collected and recorded data from wild squirrel gliders and sugar gliders.
- Installed and removed Elliott traps at study sites throughout the Brisbane area.

2.0.7 Research Intern — Busch Gardens Animal Research Center, USA

Jun 2016–Nov 2016

- Collected and analysed behavioural, physiological and parasite data across mammalian and avian species.
- Coordinated with researchers to design experiments and deliver results from multiple parallel projects.

2.0.8 Research Intern — Savannah State University Dolphin Science Lab, USA

May 2015–Aug 2015

- Collected behavioural and environmental data on bottlenose dolphins during weekly field surveys and assisted with database maintenance.
- Continued working remotely with the laboratory after the internship to complete a study examining injury rates in local dolphin populations.

3 Service Roles

2026 — Bats in Buildings Working Group Member

Contributed to FAQ resource for Australian land managers and public

2026 — UniSC HDR Retreat Organising Committee

Event planning and logistics, including scheduling, correspondence and bookings

2025-Present — Treasurer, UniSC Ecological Society

Facilitate meetings, budget acquittals and event coordination

2020-2024 — Committee Member, Wildlife

Preservation Society of QLD - Scenic Rim

Workshop and volunteer coordination

2019-Present — Wildlife Rescuer & Workshop Co-Lead, Bats Queensland

Co-lead and facilitate annual educational workshops on insectivorous bat rehabilitation

4 Grants and Awards

2024-2026 — \$20,720 AUD — Holsworth Wildlife Research Endowment — *Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland* — Lead Author

2025 — \$21,851 AUD — GBatNet Global Union of Bat Diversity Networks — *Data Deficient Bat Working Group Funding* — Co-investigator

2024 — \$49,586 AUD — WIRES National Research Grant — *Establishing vital roost characteristics to facilitate urban insectivorous bat conservation* — Co-investigator

2023 — \$2,720 AUD — Holohil Transmitter Grant Program Radio — *Transmitters for Insectivorous Bats* — Lead Author

2021 — \$49,000 AUD — Landcare Led Bushfire Recovery Grants — *Wildlife Corridors in the Scenic Rim* — Lead Author

2020 — \$1,950 AUD — Logan EnviroGrants — *Educational Workshops and Events for Bat Carers* — Lead Author

2020 — \$9,900 AUD — Logan EnviroGrants — *ICUs for Bat Carers Capacity Building* — Lead Author

2023 — \$1,197 AUD — Wildlife Acoustics Scientific Product Grant — *Bat Roost Identification* — Lead Author

5 Invited Seminars

2026-Apr — Urban Bat Ecology. GBatNet ‘My Field for Dummies’ Online Series.

2025-Oct — Bats in Our Backyards - Get to Know Our Nocturnal Neighbours. University of the Third Age Sunshine Coast.

2025-Jul — Introduction to Zotero and Scientific Citations, UniSC Ecological Society.

2024-Sep — Ecological Careers Workshop, UniSC Ecological Society.

6 Presentations and Posters

2026-Aug — Physiological tools for monitoring urban impacts at the roost level in insectivorous bats. Joint Conference of the Australian Mammal Society and Australasian Bat Society, Australia.

2025-Nov — Bats Are In The Building: Understanding Anthropogenic Roost Selection Through Habitat Models. Ecological Society of Australia Conference, Australia.

2025-Dec — Stressed out bats: developing tools to monitor physiological stress in three insectivorous species. Australian and New Zealand Society for Comparative Physiology and Biochemistry Meeting, Australia.

2025-Aug — No one size fits all: Exploring Anthropogenic roost selection across an Urban Gradient in South East Queensland. 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia.

2025-Aug — The system works: post-release survival of rehabilitated insectivorous bats in Australia. 20th International Bat Research Conference, Australia.

2025-Jul — Home is where the bats are: Bats in man-made structures in South East Queensland. Animal Ecology Seminar Series, The University of the Sunshine Coast, Australia.

2024-Apr — From rugs to rocky overhangs: diverse microclimates of natural and anthropogenic bat roosts

in South East Queensland. 21st Australasian Bat Society Conference, Australia.

2024-Apr — Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, a Public Dataset (Poster). Australasian Bat Society Conference. Australia. *Runner Up Student Poster.*

2024-Oct — *Roosting Ecology of Australian Insectivorous Bats, a Public Dataset (Poster).* North American Bat Society Conference, Mexico.

2023-Nov — *Working with Bat Landlords to Study the Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats in South East Queensland.* Australian Citizen Science Conference, Australia.

2020-Feb — *The Success of a Wildlife Corridor on Tamborine Mountain and the Value of Landcare.* Wildlife Preservation Society Scenic Rim Corridors Workshop, Australia

2019-Dec — *The Scenic Rim and Its Potential Role as an Ethical Wildlife Tourism Destination. The Scenic Rim as an Environmentally-Sustainable International Wildlife Destination Workshop,* Australia.

2018-Oct — *Can Glow-worm Ecotourism Lead to Increased Conservation Knowledge and Positive Intentions Towards Glow-worms in the Wild?* 5th National Wildlife Tourism Australia Conference, Australia.

2015-Apr — *Can Mongoose Lemurs Recognize Individual Humans? (Poster).* 23rd International Conference on Comparative Cognition, USA.

2016-Apr — *Do Common Bottlenose Dolphins That Interact with Humans Experience Greater Rates of Anthropogenic Injuries?* Southeast and Mid-Atlantic

Marine Mammal Symposium, USA. Best
Undergraduate Oral Presentation

7 Science Communication

2026-Jan — Commenting on Noosa Flying Fox Mass Entanglement Event. ABC Sunshine Coast Radio, Wide Bay, Southern Queensland

2026-Jan — Commenting on Annual Influx of Little Red Flying Foxes in the Region. ABC Sunshine Coast Radio

2024-Aug — [Commenting on Arson Incident on Moloolah Valley bat colony. ABC Sunshine Coast, ABC Australia \(https://www.abc.net.au/news/2024-08-28/arsonists-kill-48-little-bent-winged-bats-sunshine-coast/104278398\)](https://www.abc.net.au/news/2024-08-28/arsonists-kill-48-little-bent-winged-bats-sunshine-coast/104278398)

2024-Jul — [Microbats. Chicken Nuggets, Stress and Wildlife Rescue! TalkECO Podcast \(https://open.spotify.com/episode/2CKIDzUEnoRh8V33f3JMRy?si=SQ1X5U1rS2q-QFs9SO9w\)](https://open.spotify.com/episode/2CKIDzUEnoRh8V33f3JMRy?si=SQ1X5U1rS2q-QFs9SO9w)

2024-Feb — [Study to help save mini bats that fly under the radar. Sunshine Coast News \(https://www.sunshinecoastnews.com.au/2024/02/23/study-to-help-save-tiny-bats-that-fly-under-the-radar/\)](https://www.sunshinecoastnews.com.au/2024/02/23/study-to-help-save-tiny-bats-that-fly-under-the-radar/)

2024-Feb — Research to Save Tiny Bats from Housing Crisis. ABC Sunshine Coast Breakfast Radio

2023-Jul — [Little Forest Bats: Earths Tiniest Heroes, Australian Mammal of the Year Profile. Cosmos Magazine \(https://cosmosmagazine.com/nature/amoty/little-forest-bats-earths-tiniest-heroes/\)](https://cosmosmagazine.com/nature/amoty/little-forest-bats-earths-tiniest-heroes/)

8 Outreach

2026-Mar — Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk, Moreton Bay Council.

2026-Mar — Invited Speaker and Exhibit Consultant. Queensland Museum Bat Night Market Exhibit. World Science Festival Brisbane.

2025-Nov — Bats in Buildings on the Sunshine Coast. Maleny Bat Night hosted by the Sunshine Coast Council.

2025-Oct — Bats of the Sunshine Coast Workshop and Bat Walk. Mooloolah River Landcare.

2025-Oct — Bats in Your Backyard: Crash Course to the Bats of SEQ. ‘What’s Brewing Behind the Dunes Series’, Coolum CoastCare.

2024-Nov — Bat Workshop and Spotlighting Walk. UniSC Ecological Society.

2024-Oct — Impacts of Urban Living on Insectivorous Bats. Maleny Bat Night hosted by the Sunshine Coast Council.

2024-Oct — Bat Workshop and Echolocation Walk, Moreton Bay Council.

2024-Sep — Bat Call Walk and Workshop Leader. Springfield Lakes Nature Centre.

2024-May — Bats and Forests: We Need Bats More Than You Think! Maleny Wood Expo, Maleny, QLD

2024-Apr — Bat Call Walk Leader, Microbat Discovery Walk Series. Brisbane Catchments Network.

2023-Oct — Sunshine Coast Citizen Science Bat Walk, Sunshine Coast BioBlitz.

9 Skills and Certifications

- Statistical analysis in R — linear modelling, mixed modelling, spatial modelling, and temporal and spatial autocorrelation.
- Operate and Maintain 4WD Vehicle (RIIVEH305F).
- Provide Advanced Resuscitation and Oxygen Therapy First Aid (HLTAID015).
- Provide Cardiopulmonary Resuscitation — CPR (HLTAID009).

10 Referees

Dr. Clare Stawski (Primary Supervisor):
cstawski@usc.edu.au, Lecturer University of the
Sunshine Coast Dr. Alexis Levengood (Co-Supervisor):
alevengo@usc.edu.au, Research Fellow University of
the Sunshine Coast